

ISABELLA IPPOLITO

PIPELINE TECHNICAL DIRECTOR

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SKILLS

Programming

Python, VEX, PySide2, C++, Git

Systems & Pipeline

USD, PDG/TOPS, ShotGrid, publishers, asset managers, farm schedulers

DCCs

Houdini, Maya, Nuke, 3DEqualizer, Deadline

AI / ML

ONNX, ML Train Regression, LLM tools

Soft Skills

- Collaboration & Cross-Functional Teamwork
- Leadership & Mentoring
- Agile Methodology (JIRA)
- MoSCoW Planning
- Proactive Problem-Solving
- Ownership & Initiative
- Analytical Thinking

EDUCATION

BSc Creative Digital Media

First Class Honours
University of Greenwich,
London 2015 – 2018

Digital Media Design, Computing and Programming, Games Design and Development, Visual Storytelling, 3D Animation, Installation Development, Advanced 3D Animation, User Interface Design, and Interaction Design. Final Year Project: Advection of Fluids Simulations using Houdini (View [PDF](#)).

AWARDS

Netflix Animation Hackathon 2024

People's Choice — LLM Smart Search Engine.

Animal Logic Hackathon 2022

Judge's Choice — AI Art Generation with production assets.

University of Greenwich 2018

Outstanding Achievement, Digital Media.

CERTIFICATES

- AI Foundations Machine Learning, LinkedIn Learning, 2022
- Animated Women UK Helen North Achieve Programme, 2021
- Next Gen Futures VFX Bootcamp, Mayor of London
- Italian State Diploma Chemistry & Biology, 100/100
- ECDL European Computer Driving Licence
- IELTS, Kaplan English School, New York
- ESOL Trinity College, Levels 4, 5 and 7
- DELF, Diplôme d'études en langue française

VOLUNTEERING

- Mentor, University of Greenwich (2025–Present)
- Mentor, Animated Women UK (2022–Present)
- SIGGRAPH Asia Women in Tech BoF speaker (2023)
- Mentor, UTS Women in Engineering (2024)
- Volunteer usher, Greenwich Theatre

ABOUT ME

Pipeline Developer passionate about designing innovative tools and solving complex technical challenges to improve production pipelines. With experience across Animation, VFX, and Houdini development I am committed to continuous learning and growth, always seeking opportunities to expand my skills and explore new technologies.

WORK EXPERIENCE

PIPELINE TD (SUPPORT) — PIXOMONDO

London, 2025 – Present

- Supporting TV and film productions across Maya, Houdini, Nuke and USD pipeline
- Resolving technical issues with artists and department leads, code review and studio standards
- Maintaining show-based tools and delivering pipeline features as production evolves

SENIOR HOUDINI DEVELOPER — HOGARTH WPP MEDIA

London, 2025

- Built procedural Houdini tools and pipeline workflows for high-volume advertising productions
- USD/Solaris lighting workflow optimisation, Deadline + PDG/TOPs render automation

PROCEDURAL ASSETS & FX TD — NETFLIX ANIMATION / ANIMAL LOGIC

Sydney, 2023 – 2025

- Developed and supported tools for CharFX, crowds, modelling and surfacing in advanced USD/Solaris pipeline
- Implemented a custom PDG scheduler to submit and manage jobs on the studio farm, handling work items, dependencies, batching, scheduler callbacks, and farm-side support for PDG logic.
- Developed a Houdini 20 workflow using PDG and ONNX to wrap muscle and bone logic into a custom environment and HDA that outputs linear blend skinning for character workflows.
- Texture Library HDA using COPS/ROPS/TOPS/VEX; contact sheet generator ROP HDA for review workflows
- Python unit tests for FX workflows; turntables, resolvers, groom and knitting tool support

PERFORMANCE TD — NETFLIX / ANIMAL LOGIC

Sydney, 2022 – 2023

- USD asset resolver changes for layout, assets and shot entity creation workflows
- Automated character pose loading in Maya; supported shot build and review tooling
- Large-scale production support through tooling, debugging and pipeline improvements

PIPELINE TD — UNION VFX

London, 2021 – 2022

- Built ShotGrid publishing systems, custom Nuke nodes and USD + PDG pipeline transitions
- On set ingest tool with PySide and Deadline; Deadline event automations
- Contributed to ShotGrid Config transition and Houdini pipeline tooling
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RENDER WRANGLER TD — UNION VFX

London, 2019 – 2022

- Managed and optimised render farm (Deadline); automated repetitive workflows with Python
- Trained and led part-time wrangler team; collaborated with pipeline engineering

VIDEO EDITOR & MOTION DESIGNER — FREELANCE

London, 2015 – 2019

- The People's Picture including projects for NASA at the Kennedy Space Center Florida, Penguin Books, EY, Jose Cuervo, and Piccadilly Lights.
- Start Me Up Careers based in Bali